



Training for Counselors and Camp Staff Manual

Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative Camp Staff Training Manual

*Some of the materials were adapted from the
Foundation for Jewish Camps
Inclusion Training Manual and
Eye on Bullying*

Camp Staff Training

Inclusion is a Camp Value

This training packet contains a number of valuable and effective activities and exercises that will help camp staff understand the importance of including every camper in the day to day life at camp. Training materials help staff become more aware of Jewish values around inclusion and gain perspective on what it means to include someone who may be seen as different. There are activities and strategies to use with campers as well as ways to structure bunk meetings, respond to potential behavior challenges as well as how to ask for help with difficult situations.

This training packet is divided into five sections. You may introduce materials from all five sections during training week, or feature one of the five areas at your staff meetings. We urge you to read through the materials and use them.

1. Increase staff awareness of inclusion as a camp value and define what “inclusion” is.
 - The Rebbe on Inclusion-video and questions
 - What is Inclusion?
 - Different and same
 - Brainstorm: Post on Flip chart -how are we similar/how are we different
 - Language that shows respect
2. Understand concepts of Equity and Equality
 - Discuss the concepts using The Ballgame
3. Ways to support campers
 - Visual Schedules
 - Morning Routines
 - Bunk meetings
4. When I Need Help
 - Chain of command
5. Challenging Times
 - Bullying
 - Behavior

Part One: Increase Staff Awareness of Inclusion as a Camp Value and Define “Inclusion”

Video and Activity

From the Rebbe: What is Inclusion?

Materials Needed: Internet access or download the video to your laptop. A monitor or projector and screen, speakers.

http://www.chabad.org/therebbe/livingtorah/player_cdo/aid/1744438/jewish/Super-Connected.htm

Video: The Rebbe meets with the father and brother of a young person who lives with autism. From this we learn how The Rebbe teaches the value of each human being.

Follow the video with a 10 minute discussion choosing from the questions provided.

Questions

1. Why is this video called “Super Connected?”
2. What did The Rebbe mean when he said “Being autistic doesn’t mean that they don’t relate to anyone—to people they don’t relate. But to God they relate as well as anyone else, and even more.”
3. Why did The Rebbe ask the son’s age?
4. What does the son do well?
5. How did The Rebbe see the son differently than his father?
6. Why did The Rebbe ask about the young man’s involvement in *mitzvot*?
7. Why did The Rebbe emphasize the importance of *tzedakah*?
8. What did you learn from watching The Rebbe that will help you as a counselor?

What Is Inclusion?

Materials: Print out the above visual IN COLOR, one copy for every 4 people.

Break into groups of four and give each group a copy of the handout.

Explain each of the four circles:

Think about these circles as representations of communities of people. Camp is a community. This will help you understand what inclusion really means.

Have the counselors look at the four circles and discuss what they mean. Also, you can have them put a dot or mark on the sheet to indicate where they think the camp is in terms of the top circle—Inclusion. After a few minutes ask for feedback from each of the groups.

These explanations will help clarify what the circles represent for the whole group after they have their individual group discussions.

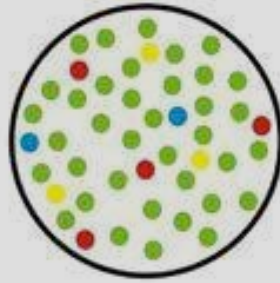
Exclusion: There are no people with disabilities in this circle. If you were someone with a disability and you encountered this community, how would you feel?

Segregation: There are no people with disabilities in the community here either because they have a separate community only for people with disabilities. Everyone here has some kind of disability and the only reason they are in this group outside of the circle is because they have a disability.

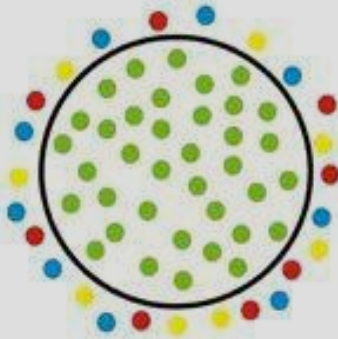
Integration: Integration means that people with disabilities have been admitted to join the community but for the most part, the people stay together in a group. For example, in this scenario, the entire camp may daven at the same time in the same room, but people who are part of the “disability group” sit together. They may interact during certain activities, but they also are separate in other activities.

Inclusion: This means that everyone gets to participate in the community like anyone else. The opportunities to participate are open to everyone. What makes this possible is that some people with disabilities may need support or assistance in order to participate. All people are seen as individuals and they are all welcome to participate in all of the activities at camp.

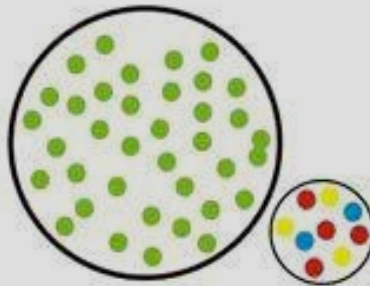
Let’s look at a few other ways that will help you to support your campers.



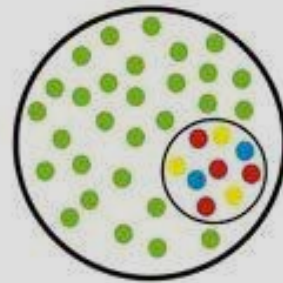
Inclusion



Exclusion



Segregation



Integration

Different and Similar

Materials Needed: Flip chart, easel, markers.

NOTE: Counselors can use this activity for a bunk meeting.

On the top page write "Different."

On the next page write "Similar."

Do one sheet at a time for this brainstorming activity. Write down their answers.

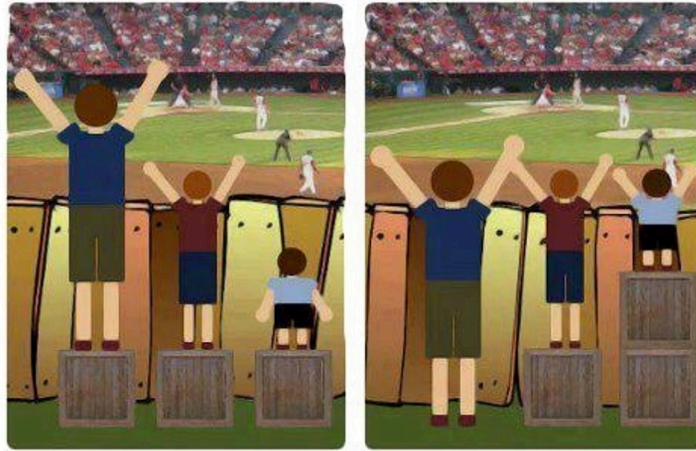
Different: Ask the group how we are all different from each other. The list might include different hair color, eye color, grade in school, hobbies, interests, etc.

Similar: Now ask the group what makes us similar. The list might include: interests, hobbies, number of kids in family, same school or grade, all are Jewish, etc.

The point of this activity is to help counselors understand that each one of us has qualities and attributes that make us different and similar as well. Having a disability is only one of those factors that may make us different. What brings us together is much greater than our differences.

Part Two: Understand Concepts of Equity, Equality and Thinking Creatively

The Ballgame



Materials Needed: Print enough COLOR copies of this picture so that each pair of counselors has a copy (a larger version can be found at the end of the training manual. Whiteboard or flip chart paper and easel, markers to record comments.

Timing: 20 minutes.

Table discussion: 5-8 minutes.

Large group reporting: 1-2 minutes per table.

Leader summarize: 4 minutes

Leader:

Table discussion: Each table will talk through these pictures and answer these questions:

1. What is going on in the picture on the left, and the picture on the right?
2. How would you label these pictures? Why?

Be sure to include all campers at the table. Choose someone to be the table reporter who will share with the large group what words you chose and why.

Large group discussion: choose one person who will share what words they put in and why. One to two minutes per table. As they answer, write the words they've chosen on a flip chart. Don't put in categories; just list the words as they give them to you.

Leader Summary and Activity Wrap up: 4 minutes:

Everyone has different needs. In the morning, some of you need more sleep, 5 extra minutes to get out of bed. You like different foods. We don't all do the same things or like the same things, yet we often think of fairness as getting and doing the same things as everyone else. Fair isn't getting the same things as everyone else. Fair is making sure that people have what they need to be successful.

Highlight the words they've mentioned on the flip chart. Look at this list—is this about fair, or being better than someone else? Each of us has something we do better than anyone else, and there are things that we each do that someone else does better. But there are times when each of us needs something to stand on like the children in the picture so that we can all succeed when we have what we need.

We are partners with Hashem—Hashem didn't make us all the same. Our world is created so that every tree, every rock, and every person is unique. Hashem doesn't do things by accident. We each have something to share with those around us, something special. When we look at it this way—we recognize that we are all special and we all have something we can offer.

Other questions:

- When your campers say “It's not fair” they often mean it's not equal. Are there times when you should treat your campers equally? When and how? When should you treat them for equity – to level the playing field among them?
- Fairness—equity—means everyone gets what he or she needs to succeed. How can you create equity in your bunk community? How can you teach campers the difference between equality and equity?

Part 3: Identify ways to support campers

Create Visual Schedules

Schedules and Planning Transitions

Materials: Print out this page and the next two as handouts. Talk about the difference between the written schedule and the visual schedule and why the visual schedule might be a better way to help campers plan what is going to happen at camp that day.

This traditional list of daily activities is helpful for planning purposes, but the visual schedule on the next two pages is recommended to display in the bunk for all of your campers. Kids really enjoy visual schedules and for many it helps them anticipate transitions throughout the day, easing anxiety and changes. You can find free images using your search engine.

8:00 Wake Up
8:30 Line Up – Flagpole
8:40 Breakfast
9:20 Learning Groups
10:15 Cabin Clean Up
10:45 1st Morning Activity
11:35 Snacks
11:50 2nd Morning Activity
12:50 Wash Up
1:00 Lunch
1:45 Rest & Relaxation Time
2:30 1st Afternoon Activity (Electives)
3:30 2nd Afternoon Activity
4:20 Snacks
4:30 3rd Afternoon Activity
5:30 Shower Hour
6:30 Line up – Flagpole
7:00 Dinner
7:45 Rest & Relaxation Time
8:15 Night Activity
9:15 Cabin Time
9:45 Lights Out

7:15-7:45	Wake Up 
7:45-8:30	T'filah 
8:30-9:15	Breakfast 
9:15-10:00	Clean the Bunk 
10:00-11:00	Swim 
11:00-12:00	Drama 
12:00-1:00	Sports 

1:00-1:45	Lunch 
1:45-2:30	Rest 
2:30-3:30	Music 
3:30-4:30	Tennis 
4:30-5:30	Nature 
5:30-6:30	Shower 
6:30-7:15	Dinner 
7:15-8:30	Evening 
8:30	Bedtime 

Day Camp Schedule

THEMES	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
 UNDER THE SEA	JUN27 NO CAMP	JUN28 First day of camp! 	JUN29 Trip! Gr. 2-6 Girls Douglas Snow Aquatic Centre Gr. 1 Girls & JK-SK Bunch of Fun	JUN30 Trip! Gr. 2-6 Boys & Mahara! Douglas Snow Aquatic Centre Gr. 1 Boys B. of Fun	JUL1  Crazy Hat Day!
WILD WEST 	JUL4 	JUL5 	JUL6 Trip!  Boys, Girls, & JK-SK Planet Fun	JUL7 Trip!  Mahara! Planet Fun	JUL8  Purin Dress Up!
CHALLENGE YOURSELF! 	First day of swim! 	Swim! 	JUL13 Trip!  Boys, Girls, & JK-SK Bowling	JUL14 Trip!  Mahara! Bowling	JUL15  Face Paint Day!
 SPIN THE WHEEL	Swim! 	JUL19 	JUL20 Trip!  All Camps	JUL21 Mahara! Planet Fun	JUL22  Twin Day!
SIMCHA WEEK 	JUL25 Swim!	JUL26 	JUL27 Trip!  All Camps	JUL28  Jungle Cat World	JUL29  Crazy Hair Day!
NATURE WEEK 	AUG1 Swim!	AUG2 	AUG3 Trip!  All Camps	AUG4  Brooks Farm	AUG5  Swim!
FRIENDSHIP WEEK 	AUG8 Swim!	AUG9 	AUG10 Trip!  Boys & Girls	AUG11  Mini Golf	AUG12  Pajama Day!
 TALENT	4 Av AUG15 Swim!	5 Av AUG16 Sneak	AUG17 Trip! Gr. 3-6 Surprise Trip! Gr. 1-2 & JK-SK	7 Av AUG18 Last day of camp	AUG19 NO CAMP

NOTES

- Regularly scheduled swim for Gr. 2-6 campers begins on July 4th in accordance with the permit issued by the City of Toronto and Newtonbrook pool.
- JK-SK and Gr. 1 campers have water play on-site daily beginning with the first day of camp. Please send bathing suits and towels to camp daily.



2016/5776

Morning

Routines



WWW.RCII.ORG | 701-404-RCII | INFO@RCII.ORG



Morning Routine Activity One

This section contains two ways to offer the Morning Routine. The first is an engaging activity that helps staff understand the importance of routines for their campers. If you are limited in time you can choose Morning Routine Activity Two, which is discussion, based.

Materials Needed:

Blank paper to write routine on

Pens or pencils

Tape to hang routines up on the wall

The Activity:

Ask people to write down their morning routine during the school year and to be as specific as possible. Read the questions below as they begin to write:

What's your morning routine?

- What time do you wake up? Do you use an alarm clock or your cell phone alarm? Do you hit the snooze button? How many times?
- What's the first thing you do when you get out of bed? Talk to your dog or cat? Do you look in the mirror? Do you put your slippers on?
- Do you wash your face with bar soap or a cleanser? What brand do you use? Are your hair and body products fragrant or unfragrant? Do you use a specific

kind of toothpaste? What is the brand? What about dental floss? Do you use skinny floss or thicker floss? Do you brush before breakfast, after or both?

- Do you get dressed before you eat breakfast? Do you lay your clothes out the night before or do you go in your closet and grab whatever's closest to the closet door?
- Do you eat breakfast? What do you have for breakfast? Do you eat cereal? What kind? Do you add milk? Skim or 2%? Do you have eggs every day? How many? How do you prepare them? Do you always have a slice or two of toast with that? Do you put butter or jam or both on your toast? Where do you eat? In front of the TV? Sitting at the kitchen table or on your deck or patio?
- How do you get to school? Do you take a bus? Does someone drive you? Who? What's the first thing you do when you get to school?

Have each person hang her morning routine on the wall and stand in front of it. Ask one or two people to read their morning routines.

Now, have people move 3 places to the right so that they are standing in front of someone else's morning routine. Have them read the routine to themselves. Tell them that this is their new morning routine and starting tomorrow morning, this is the routine they will have.

Spend about 5 minutes and ask them how having this new morning routine feels. Is it uncomfortable to have a different routine? Does it feel unfamiliar? Are there things in that morning routine that you've never done before? Do you feel prepared for a new morning routine? What changes will you have to make? Does that scare you? How do you feel about that? Do you see any reason to adopt a new morning routine?

The discussion follows as to how to help campers adapt to new routines at camp, especially if they have never been to camp before or the routines of the day may be different than they expect. How can they provide a new structure and help campers adjust to routines that are different? What impact might it have by guiding campers through their routines? Do you think that there will be more or less behavioral situations?

Morning Routine Activity Two

Morning Routine Activity Two is a good way to engage counselors and get them up and moving when you have less time for Activity One.

Counselors are seated. When you start asking the questions below, have them stand and move to join others who have the same answers. They will be changing groups with each answer.

What's your morning routine?

- How many of you jump out of bed at the first sound of the alarm? How many of you hit the snooze button for 10 more minutes? How many of you just wish you could stay in bed all day?
- How many of you get dressed before you eat breakfast? How many of you get dressed after you eat breakfast?
- How many of you eat breakfast? How many of you skip breakfast?
- How many of you read the paper? How many of you go online? How many of you watch TV? How many of you don't do anything electronic in the morning?
- How many of you lay your clothes out the night before? How many of you go in your closet and grab whatever's closest to the closet door?
- Do you brush before breakfast, after or both?
- How do you get to school? Do you take a bus? Does someone drive you? What's the first thing you do when you get to school?

The discussion follows as to how to help campers adapt to new routines at camp, especially if they have never been to camp before or the routines of the day may be different than they expect. How can they provide a new structure and help campers adjust to routines that are different? What impact might it have by guiding campers through their routines? Do you think that there will be more or less behavioral situations?

Camper Bunk Meetings



Camper bunk meetings serve several purposes and functions.

- They are wonderful bonding opportunities, which allow the bunk members to get close to each other and to their counselors.
- They provide opportunities to share feelings and concerns.
- Bunk meetings are particularly effective in dealing with feelings about a certain camper behavior. It is important to not place blame, but rather to share openly and seek solutions.

What does a Camper Bunk Meeting Look Like?

- They should ideally take place with each camper and staff member sitting in a circle, on the floor of the bunk.
- Counselors might introduce a fun activity (making friendship bracelets) or an ice breaker (two truths and a lie).
- The meetings may be used for sharing on a given topic (a camp wide issue, a world affairs issue, etc.), or it may be used for problem solving and processing.
- It is sometimes useful to invite a more experienced senior staff member to lead or co-facilitate the meeting, particularly if feelings about certain camper behavior will be discussed.

Rebbe Time

This is a great time to introduce the theme of *Ahavat Yisroel* and inclusion into your discussions.

Part 4: When I Need Help

Bunk Counselors Roles, Responsibilities and Chain of Command

Each person in camp has an important job and role to play in the lives of our campers. It is important to know what is in each person's job description and who to go to for help. One great thing about camp is that we never have to feel alone and unsupported. There is always somebody a little more senior, experienced and with expertise who can help us. If we all complete our jobs to the best of our abilities, and follow the chain of command, everyone will have a safe, positive camp experience.

Roles

- works with co-counselors as part of camper care team
- supervision and management of all aspects of bunk life
 - Safety
 - Hygiene
 - Health and wellness
 - Tiredness
 - Cleanliness
 - Bunk activities
- monitor campers for signs of homesickness
- assist campers to resolve conflicts with peers in the bunk/division
- participate in weekly camper care meetings
- plan divisional activities and participate in committees as assigned by division head
- serve as a *dugma chaya* (a positive role model) for your campers
- help campers adjust to life at camp
- enforce camp rules and policies (i.e. use of phones and tablets)
- plan weekly bunk (bonding) activities and run weekly check in meetings
- make sure to spend at least a few minutes 1 on 1 with each camper each day (follow the "rule of 3"--never be alone with 1 camper)

When to "report up":

- when you have questions or concerns about something at camp
- when you have a "gut feeling" something isn't right or going well for your campers
- when you are unsure of how to manage a bunk situation
- when you are "stuck" or unsure of how to resolve an issue with your co-counselor(s)
- when you witness or suspect bullying (verbal or physical)
- when a camper talks of hurting herself (or has thoughts, or a plan, or has taken action i.e. cutting)
- when a camper asks you to "keep a secret" (and it is more "serious" than a crush on a boy!)
- when a camper talks of abuse (at camp or at home)

Chains of Command:

For Administrative Issues (questions about camp policy and procedures)/Camper Behavioral Issues and Mental Health Concerns:

- Counselor
- Co-Counselors
- Division Head
- Assistant Director
- Director

For Health and Medical Issues:

If non emergency: Division Head

If emergency (including but not limited to): seizure, excessive bleeding, loss of consciousness.

CALL 911 or local first responders.

Part 5: Challenging Behaviors

Bullying

Materials adapted from eyesonbullying.com toolkit

Prevent Bullying

We believe that to prevent bullying in children's lives, children and adults must:

- Take a new look at the ways they think about bullying
- Understand how their actions—or inaction—can either prevent or escalate bullying behaviors
- Take responsibility and action for preventing bullying
- Learn and teach each other successful strategies and skills to prevent bullying
- Create an environment where rules of conduct are clear, children feel safe and everyone understands that bullying will not be tolerated.

What is the Impact of Bullying?

- Bullying damages the physical, social, and emotional well-being of its victims. It also hurts the children who bully as well as those who watch it happen.
- Bullying creates a climate of fear, callousness and disrespect for everyone involved.
- Bullying begins in the preschool years, peaks in early adolescence, and continues but with less frequency into the high school years. But bullying does NOT have to be a part of growing up.
- Over the past two decades, what we know about bullying—who's involved, where, when and why it occurs, and the situations that allow it to spread—has increased tremendously. This knowledge has helped researchers develop new and useful strategies that both children and adults can use to intervene effectively and better yet, prevent bullying before it ever occurs.

What Is Bullying?

Understanding what bullying looks like will help you stop it before it escalates.

Bullying is a form of emotional or physical abuse that has three defining characteristics:

- 1 Deliberate—a bully's intention is to hurt someone
- 2 Repeated—a bully often targets the same victim again and again
- 3 Power Imbalanced—a bully chooses victims he or she perceives as vulnerable

Bullying occurs in many different forms, with varying levels of severity. It may involve:

- Physical bullying—poking, pushing, hitting, kicking, beating up
- Verbal bullying—yelling, taunting, name calling, insulting, threatening to harm
- Relational bullying—excluding, spreading rumors, getting others to hurt someone

Bullying Basics

Bullying is **NOT** pre-wired, harmless, or inevitable

Bullying **IS** learned, harmful, and controllable

Bullying **SPREADS** if supported or left unchecked

Bullying **INVOLVES** everyone—bullies, victims, and bystanders

Bullying **CAN BE** effectively stopped or entirely prevented

Do your beliefs promote or prevent bullying?

Can you remember times when you were repeatedly teased, humiliated, or shut out of a group? When you were forced to do something you didn't want to do by someone you considered more powerful than you? When **YOU** intentionally hurt someone who was vulnerable, or witnessed this happening to someone else? If you are like most people, you remember... and these memories can last a lifetime.

Story Swap

Talking about bullying can help. Children may be reluctant to share their experiences because they believe their situation is unique, embarrassing, or shameful. They may think adults can't understand or help. But hearing a story about an adult's bullying experiences may move a child to reveal his or her own experiences.

- 1 Remember your own childhood story of initiating, experiencing, or witnessing bullying.
- 2 Share your story with the children in your care and explain how it made you feel then and now.
- 3 Ask children to share their own bullying story. (When in a group, have children substitute fictional names for real ones.) Acknowledge that children might feel embarrassed or afraid to recount their experience in front of others.

4 Discuss how the stories made them feel—to tell and to hear.

5 Tell children that bullying should not happen. Brainstorm suggestions for things children can do to stop or prevent bullying, using the stories they told as examples. You may want to write down their responses. Later, after they have worked through the toolkit, return to this exercise to see how their responses may have changed.

6 Invite children to write a story about a bullying experience. Encourage young children to draw pictures. These may be the preferred options for children who are uncomfortable sharing their experiences aloud.

A culture of silence often surrounds bullying. Many children who are bullied never tell anyone. Most bullying is NOT reported because children:

- Don't recognize it as bullying
- Are embarrassed
- Don't want to appear weak
- Believe they deserve it
- Want to belong
- Fear retaliation
- Don't know how to talk about it
- Don't have a trusted adult to confide in
- Think adults won't understand
- Think nothing can be done about it

Even if you don't observe bullying. It may be occurring. Watch for these warning signs:

- Loss of interest in activities
- Unexplained loss of personal items or clothing
- Unusually sad, moody, anxious, lonely or depressed
- Evidence of physical abuse such as bruises and scratches
- Problems with eating, sleeping, bed-wetting
- Loss of friends or changes in friends
- Headaches, stomach aches or other physical complaints
- Reluctance to participate in activities with peers
- Thoughts of suicide

Pay careful attention to these red flags, watch and listen carefully, especially if the warning signs escalate. Some children may withdraw, while others may get angry and seek revenge. Don't assume the problem will go away on its own. Invite children to talk about what is bothering them. If you find out a child is being bullied, show support, help develop a response strategy and follow up to make sure the bullying does not continue.

Who is Involved?

Bullies, Victims and Bystanders

Bullying involves three parties: bullies, victims and bystanders. Each can help make bullying stop. Bullying is learned behavior, and it can also be “unlearned” or even changed so that it’s not learned or tolerated in the first place.

How Does Bullying Work?

Bullies select and train their victims to comply to their demands. Active encouragement, passive acceptance or silence from bystanders reinforces the behavior. Bullies can be stopped when victims and bystanders apply new ways to stand up to bullying. Bullies can learn new behavior to help them make friends and get what they need by helping, not hurting others.

Victims reward bullying behavior by showing signs of intimidation and yielding control. They often avoid reporting bullying or receive support from bystanders. Victims can learn to respond assertively, gaining support from bystanders, and reporting the bullying to adults.

Bystanders can play a role in promoting or preventing bullying. They promote bullying by providing an audience for the bully, being silent, encouraging or joining in. Bystanders can neutralize or stop the bullying by coming to the aid of the victim, gaining support from other bystanders and getting help from adults.

Group Activity and Discussion: Bullying Scenarios

Materials Needed: A copy of this page for each counselor.

Divide into five groups. Assign each group a scenario to discuss. Then have each group report on their discussions. They have to determine, in the group, what submissive, hurting back and assertive would look like and then present to the larger group. If there is a safety issue in your scenario include this in your discussion. They can create a role play for each scenario, if time.

Group One: It's swim time. There is a camper who is afraid of the water and really needs an adult to work with them to get comfortable. The bully has noticed this and when the camper is standing on the shore waiting for the adult who is going to work with them that day, the bully says to the camper, "you don't even know how to swim! That's stupid! I'll teach you how to swim!" and laughs while she pushes the camper in the water.

Group Two: It's dinnertime and the bully is sitting on the bench one side of the table. The other side of the table is filled, and a camper comes over and sits on the bully's side. The bully moves over and pushes the camper off the bench and says, "you're not sitting with me. You eat funny and watching you makes me sick!"

Group Three: There is a camper who does not like to take showers. This is something that you, as the counselor, know about, and you have worked out with the parents and the camp staff that the camper will wash up at the end of the day by herself. The bully notices that this camper never showers when the rest of the bunk does and one day says to her in front of the rest of the bunk, "Why don't you take showers like the rest of us? You stink! You smell! I can't stand to be around you! It's not fair that I have to smell your stinky self."

Group Four: There are two new campers in the bunk this year. The other girls know each other from previous years and one of them has helped the new campers by explaining the routine and showing them around camp. The bully has been going to camp longer than anyone and feels that she should be the one showing the new campers around. She says to the new campers, "Don't hang out with that girl. If you want people to like you at camp, you have to hang out with me. If you hang out with her, no one will like you and you won't have any friends in camp."

Group Five: Some of the campers brought their teddy bears from home. They usually hide them in their bunk and only take them out at night. However, one day the bully was nosing around the bunk of a girl who she has taken a dislike to, and found her teddy bear. The bully shoves the teddy bear in the girl's face, and says, "You are such a baby! Only babies bring their teddy bears to camp. Here's your teddy bear you little baby! Stupid teddy bear!"

Group Activity and Discussion: Every Behavior Has a Purpose What Can You Do When...



Every behavior has a purpose. It can be challenging to know how to react when a camper is communicating through difficult behavior. These five brainstorm activities give you the opportunity to brainstorm different ways of responding in anticipation or in response to campers' behavior. Counselors should leave this session knowing that behavior is a form of communication. They should learn to be behavior detectives, working to uncover and address the root causes of their campers' behaviors, rather than reacting to the behaviors. Counselors will receive tips to help them preempt negative behaviors and become proactive in encouraging positive ones. Counselors should also walk away knowing that they are not alone, and that there are many people in camp available to support them as they develop these skills.

You can divide your staff into five groups. Give each group a copy of the behaviors listed on the next page. Assign each group a set of behaviors and discuss how they would handle a situation when a camper demonstrated a set of behaviors. At the end of the session, each group can report back to the larger group. You can also use this training to develop role-playing situations.

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 1

Defiance

Aggression

Irritability

Anger

Fighting

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 2

Rigid behaviors

Difficult transitions

Obsessive behavior

Perimeter walking

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 3

Sensory issues: heat, noise, smells, dirt, sand, crowds, physical exhaustion

Eating issues

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 4

Moodiness

Something bothering the camper but they won't talk about it

Non-participating

Kids who march to their own drummer

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 5

Overactive

Hyperactive

Spacey

Running ahead